Somang Kim

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Geography, The University of Texas at Austin, Austin, TX, USA
Advisor: Dr. Yuhao Kang GPA: 4.0/4.0 Aug. 2025 – Current

M.A. in Geography, Ewha Womans University, Seoul, South Korea
Advisor: Dr. Youngok Kang GPA: 3.92/4.0 Sep. 2023 – Aug. 2025

B.A. in Geography Education, Ewha Womans University, Seoul, South Korea
Minors: Computer Science and Engineering GPA: 3.86/4.0, Summa Cum Laude Feb. 2020 – Aug. 2023

RESEARCH INTERESTS

GeoAI; GIScience; Human Subjective Experiences of Places; Neuro-Geography; Visual Urban Perception; Spatial Big Data Analytics; Geospatial Visualization; Neuroscience.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Kim, S.**, Wang, J., & Kang, Y. (2026). The Place You See: Reconstructing Geographical Imagination from Brain Signals Using the Mind2Place Diffusion Model. *Annals of the American Association of Geographers*, In revision
- Guo, S., **Kim, S.**, Wang, J., Kang, Y., & Qin, T. (2026). The Place You Think Is Beyond What You See: Understanding Neural Representations of Place from AI-Embedded MEG Signals. *Computers, Environment and Urban Systems*, In revision.
- **Kim, S.**, Choi, J., & Kang, Y. (2026). Modeling and Explaining Perceived Fear of Crime from Street View Imagery Using a GeoAI Framework. *ISPRS International Journal of Geo-Information, 15*(1), 18. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijgi15010018
- **Kim, S.**, & Kang, Y. (2025). Predicting Fear of Crime and Evaluating CPTED-based Crime Safety Design Using Street View Images and Deep Learning. *Journal of the Korean Geographical Society, 60*(5), 576–592. https://doi.org/10.22776/kgs.2025.60.5.576
- Choi, J., **Kim, S.**, Noh, S., & Kang, Y. (2024). Comparison of physical and perceived walking environment using street view images and deep learning technology. *Journal of the Korean Cartographic Association, 24*(3), 45–60. https://doi.org/10.16879/jkca.2024.24.3.045
- Choi, J., Noh, S., **Kim, S.**, & Kang, Y. (2024). Assessing walkability using street view images and semantic segmentation technique. *Journal of the Korean Geographical Society, 59*(5), 673–687. https://doi.org/10.22776/kgs.2024.59.5.673
- **Kim, S.**, Choi, J., & Kang, Y. (2024). Measurement and visualization of perceived fear of crime by street level using street view images and deep learning technology. *Journal of the Korean Cartographic Association, 24*(1), 71–84. https://doi.org/10.16879/jkca.2024.24.1.071
- Choi, J., **Kim, S.**, & Kang, Y. (2024). Where do you think is better to walk? Evaluation of the perceived walking environment using street view images and deep learning model based on Siamese Neural Network. *Journal of the Korean Urban Geographical Society, 27*(1), 65–79. https://doi.org/10.21189/JKUGS.27.1.5

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Exploring Human Perception of AI and Authentic Imagery through fNIRS. Mar. 20, 2026
2026 AAG Annual Meeting, San Francisco. *Oral presentation.*

Measurement and Visualization of Perceived Fear of Crime at Street Level using Street View Images and Deep Learning Technology. Dec. 10, 2024
International Cartographic Association: Asian Cartographic Conference (Asia Carto 2024), Hong Kong. *Oral presentation.*

Predicting Fear of Crime in Urban Streetscapes using Swin Transformer and Siamese Network. Oct. 25, 2024
Korea Spatial Information Society. *Oral presentation.*

Measurement and Visualization of Perceived Fear of Crime at Street Level using Street View Images and Deep Learning Technology. 2024 The Korean Cartographic Association Conference. *Oral presentation.* Jun. 1, 2024

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Encoding Experience. Autodesk Research Residency — Sep. 2026 – Current

The Geography of Opportunity for Latino Students in Texas. The Population Research Center (PRC), The University of Texas at Austin. — Jan. 2026 – Current

GeoImagine Project. GISense Lab, The University of Texas at Austin. Investigating how the brain represents geographic environments: developing the Mind2Place diffusion model to reconstruct geographic scenes from brain signals; designing fMRI experiments and collecting data at the Biomedical Imaging Center (pilot scanning scheduled for Oct. 20, 2026). — Aug. 2025 – Current

Perceived Safety Measurement and Crime Safety Evaluation by Street Level using Deep Learning Technology. National Research Foundation (NRF), South Korea. — Jun. 2023 – Aug. 2025

TEACHING AND WORK EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, The University of Texas at Austin
GRG 460 Environmental GIS: Introduction to GIS, Fall 2025 — Aug. 2025 – Dec. 2025

Research Assistant, GIS Lab, Ewha Womans University — Jun. 2023 – Aug. 2025

CERTIFICATIONS

Level 2 MRI Certification, Biomedical Imaging Center (BIC), The University of Texas at Austin. *In progress.* — Expected Nov. 2026

Level 1 MRI Certification, Biomedical Imaging Center (BIC), The University of Texas at Austin. — Dec. 2025

SCHOLARSHIPS AND FELLOWSHIPS

CaGIS Cyber Training Workshop Travel Grant, Cartography and Geographic Information Society (CaGIS), USA, US$500. — Summer 2026

Department of Geography and the Environment Travel Award, The University of Texas at Austin, Travel support for the 2026 AAG Annual Meeting, US$500. — Mar. 2026

ICA Scholarship for AsiaCarto 2024, International Cartographic Association, US$250. — Dec. 10, 2024

The Best Ewhain Scholarship, Ewha Womans University, Seoul, South Korea. — Sep. 2023 – Aug. 2025

Graduate School of Geospatial Information Specialization Scholarship, Spatial Information Industry Promotion Agency, South Korea. — Sep. 2023 – Aug. 2025

HONORS AND AWARDS

Best Student Paper Presentation Award, AsiaCarto 2024, International Cartographic Association. — Dec. 2024

2022 Spatial Data Analysis and Visualization Contest, Excellence Award. Title: Classification of Myeong-dong Street Food Images Using Transfer Learning of Deep Learning Model, Ewha Womans University, Seoul, South Korea. — Dec. 2022